

Unit Y314: The Challenge of German Nationalism 1789–1919

This theme focuses on significant developments in Germany which characterised nationalism in different forms from the emerging movement in the early 19th century to the achievement of unification and finally the collapse of monarchy. Learners should understand the reasons for changes in the nature of German nationalism and the consequences within

Germany. The strands identified below are not to be studied in isolation to each other.

Learners are not expected to demonstrate a detailed understanding of the specification content, except for the named in-depth studies, but are expected to know the main developments and turning points relevant to the theme.

Thematic Study: The Challenge of German Nationalism 1789–1919	
Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
Social and intellectual forces	The origins and growth of German nationalism from 1789; the impact of Napoleon and the Congress of Vienna; different views, Kleindeutsch v Grossdeutsch; the impact of the 1848/1849 revolutions and the Frankfurt Parliament; mass nationalism and its appeal in the 19 th and early 20 th centuries; the Kulturkampf; Pan-Germanism; radical nationalism; the impact of the First World War and defeat.
Economic forces	Economic nationalism and modernisation; the Zollverein; economic integration; the economic and social effects of industrialisation including the rise of socialism; the impact of railways; arguments for free trade and protection; the effect of economic change on nationalism and national unity.
Political and military forces	Managing German nationalism and its opponents; assessment and comparison of the contributions of Napoleon, Metternich, Bismarck and Wilhelm II; the impact of external forces and circumstances on German nationalism including the decline of Austria; the role of warfare in uniting Germany; the Treaty of Versailles; political challenges from the left and right.
The extent of Unification	The extent to which Germany and the German people became a united nation in the course of the period; continuing cultural, religious and regional differences; wars as a unifying or divisive influence; the role of Prussia in the development of Germany; constitutional developments; the treatment of Germany's minorities; the contribution of political groups (liberals, conservatives, socialists and communists); the extent to which the new Germany was made and subsequently dominated by Prussia hence 'extent' to which it was genuinely united.

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Depth Studies	Content Learners should be aware of debates surrounding the issues outlined for each in-depth topic:
1848/1849 Revolutions	The social and intellectual forces behind the revolutions; the impact of the revolutions on the development of nationalism; the consequences of the Frankfurt Parliament; economic factors as a cause of the Revolutions; the response of Metternich and the authorities to the Revolutions; support for, and opposition to, the 1848/1849 Revolutions.
Nationalism and Unification 1867–1871	Bismarck's contribution and role; the use of popular feeling; the impact of external forces; the extent to which the war with France unified people; the war and continuing cultural, religious and regional differences; reasons for Prussian victory; consequences of the war and constitutional developments; the relative importance of Bismarck's statesmanship and contextual factors 1862–1871.
Wilhelmine Germany and the growth of Nationalism 1884–1914	Character and ideas of Wilhelm II; the end of Bismarck's period as Chancellor and its significance for Germany's foreign policy; foreign policy aims and methods; Wilhelm II and the Reichstag; military growth, the development of a German navy and its impact, the role of the army in German society and policy-making; German economic growth and its impact; the responsibility of the Kaiser and his government for the First World War.